FOREST ABODES

Coracle rides or foot safaris by day, nocturnal trails by night, and creature comforts in between—here are the best wildlife lodges all over India for the coming season

By PRANAY CHANDER



Jamoon, Uttarakhand

Set at the edge of **Corbett National Park**, on the banks of Ramganga, with its own waterhole and machan, Jamoon offers an intimate experience of the Terai belt in Uttarakhand. Five tents are available currently, but no electricity or internet. Activities offered include walking safaris by the river, stargazing, hide and camera-trap photography, and pugmark-casting. *Thejamoon.com*

Wayanad Wild, Kerala

Wayanad—northern Kerala's verdant, rainforested paradise—has always been synonymous with cascading spice plantations and mist-swaddled Ghats. Ensconced within the **Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve**, Wayanad Wild seeks to widen the narrative under the helm of naturalist David Raju. The property is spread over 12 acres of forest that's home to a rich variety of avifauna, and has 20 cosy rooms perched over treetops. Night expeditions to experience the forest's nocturnal life, birding and photography tours and day treks, which the lodge also organises for children, are among the offerings. *cghearth.com/wayanad-wild*



Svasara Jungle Lodge, Maharashtra

Situated close to **Tadoba Tiger Reserve**'s Kolara Gate, this charming property enjoys a peaceful setting. The reserve's dry deciduous forest is punctuated by patches of grassland and populated by more than 70 tigers. The 10-acre property, a 'safari-chic' boutique lodge, offers 12 suites each with its private sitout. Most visitors come for Tadoba's celebrity tigress Maya, but forest walks, exploring the area on bicycles and visiting a local craft centre are just as captivating. *svasararesorts.com*

Snow Leopard Lodge, Ladakh

India's northernmost Union Territory can get unimaginably cold in the winter months, but that's a meagre price to pay for a rendezvous with the snow leopard. **Uley**'s Snow Leopard Lodge, which started out as a homestay intended to aid conservation of the elusive big cat, is operational from November to April, and located in an area frequented by ibexes, Tibetan wolves and birds such as Himalayan vultures and golden eagles. The property has 11 rooms, a lounge area and an annexe, all of them centrally heated. *snowleopardlodge.com*